

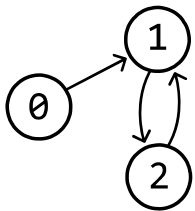


Prerequisites

Given an integer n representing the number of courses labeled from 0 to $n - 1$, and an array of prerequisite pairs, determine if it's possible to enroll in all courses.

Each prerequisite is represented as a pair $[a, b]$, indicating that course a must be taken before course b .

Example:



Input: $n = 3$, $\text{prerequisites} = [[0, 1], [1, 2], [2, 1]]$

Output: False

Explanation: Course 1 cannot be taken without first completing course 2 and, and vice versa.

Constraints:

- For any prerequisite $[a, b]$, a will not equal b .

Intuition

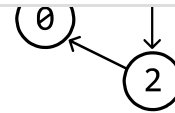
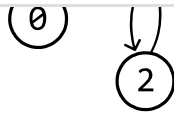
Our goal is to check if enrollment into all courses is possible. Let's start by identifying which situations make enrollment impossible.

Consider a simple case where there are just two courses. A scenario where enrollment into all courses is impossible occurs when each course is a prerequisite to the other, as graphically represented below:

$\text{prerequisites} = [[0, 1], [1, 0]]$



Here are a couple of impossible enrollment scenarios that could occur with prerequisites for three courses:

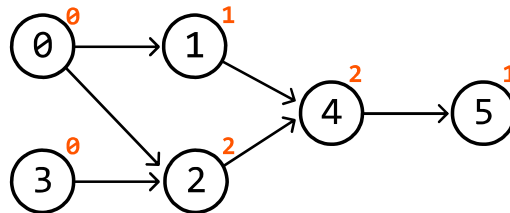


What do we notice about these cases and their graphical representations? They both have a circular relationship: a cycle. This highlights that it's impossible to enroll in all courses if there exists a circular dependency between courses. In other words, **there must not be a cycle in the graphical representation of the courses** for complete enrollment to be possible.

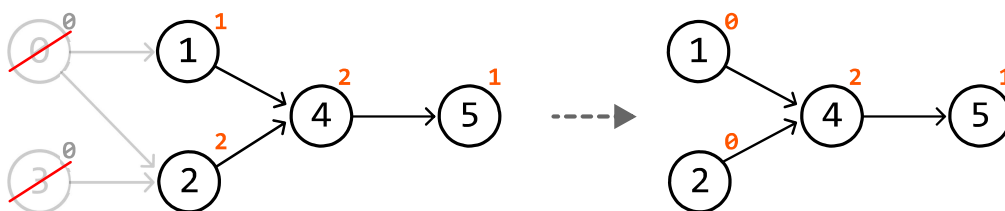
Another thing to note is that the first courses which can be completed are those without prerequisites. In the graphical representation, such a course would have no directed arrows pointing at them. Let's refer to the number of directed edges incoming to a node as the **in-degree** of that node.

In the example below, each node's in-degree is displayed at the top right:

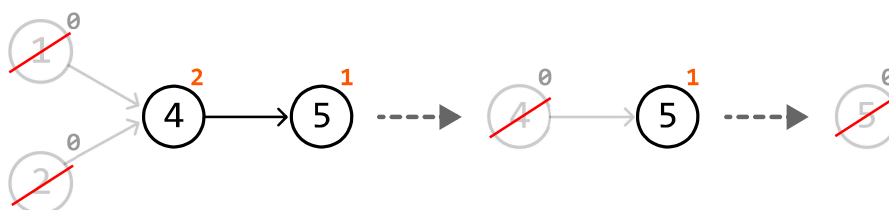
```
prerequisites = [[0,1] [0,2] [3,2] [1,4], [2,4], [4,5]]
```



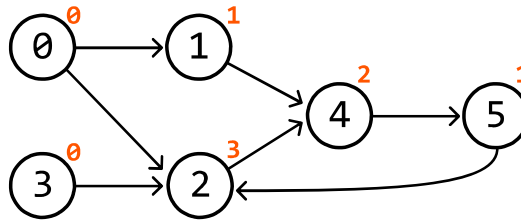
Courses 0 and 3 have an in-degree of 0. So, let's complete them first and remove them from the graph. By doing this, we reduce the number of prerequisites for courses 1 and 2. Course 1's indegree then decreases by 1, and course 2's indegree decreases by 2:



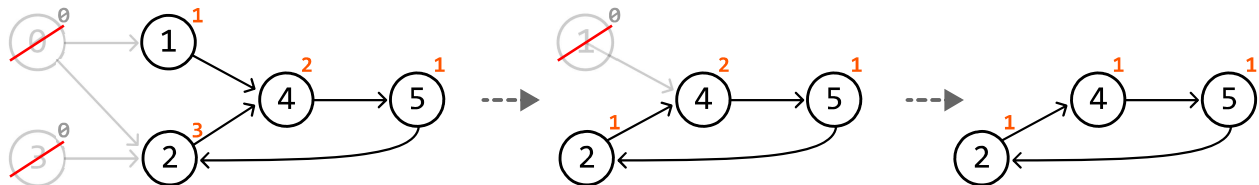
Now, courses 1 and 2 have an in-degree of 0, which means we can enroll in them and remove them from the graph. Observe what happens when we continue the process of removing courses with an in-degree of 0 from the graph:



By the end of this process, no courses remain, indicating it's possible to enroll in all courses.



Let's follow the same steps of removing courses with an in-degree of 0:



Here, there is no way to progress because there aren't any courses with an in-degree of 0. When this happens, and there are still unvisited courses, a cyclic dependency exists, meaning enrolment is impossible.

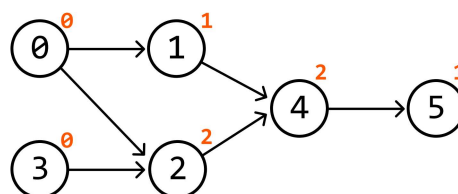
Now, let's identify a way to simulate the above process algorithmically.

Topological sort

The process we described above is essentially topological sorting, where vertices of a graph are sorted in such a way that for every directed edge $u \rightarrow v$, node u comes before node v in the ordering of the topological sort.

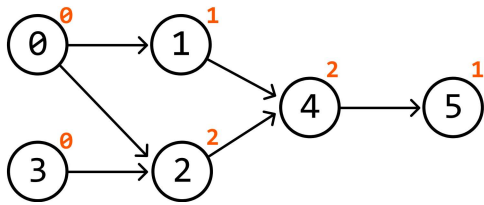
An algorithm designed to perform topological sort is **Kahn's algorithm**. Let's see how we can use it to solve this problem.

The first step of Kahn's algorithm is to determine the in-degree of each course. This can be achieved by counting the number of times each course appears as a dependent in the prerequisite pairs: for a pair $[a, b]$, course b depends on course a , so course b 's in-degree is incremented by one:



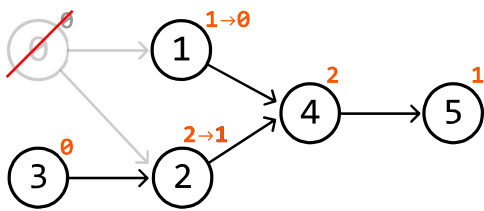
prerequisites = $[[0,1] [0,2] [3,2] [1,4] [2,4] [4,5]]$

in_degrees = $[0 \quad 1 \quad 2 \quad 0 \quad 2 \quad 1]$
 0 1 2 3 4 5



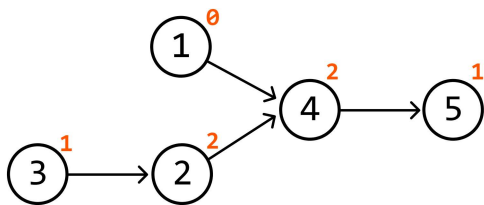
in_degrees = [0 1 2 0 2 1]
 queue = [0 3]

To begin processing, pop the first course from the queue: course 0. Then, for each course that has course 0 as a prerequisite (i.e., courses pointed to by course 0), reduce their in-degree by one:



in_degrees = [0 1 2 0 2 1]
 queue = [0 3]

If any of the courses have an in-degree of 0 after being decremented, add them to the queue. Course 1 now has an in-degree of 0, so we add it to the queue:



in_degrees = [0 0 1 0 2 1]
 queue = [3 1]

We can continue the above process until the queue is empty, indicating that there aren't any more courses with an in-degree of 0.

- If we've processed all n courses, enrollment to all courses is possible.
- If we couldn't process all n courses, a cycle was found, indicating enrollment to all courses is impossible.

Implementation

Python

JavaScript

Java

```
from typing import List
from collections import defaultdict, deque

def prerequisites(n: int, prerequisites: List[List[int]]) -> bool:
    graph = defaultdict(list)
    in_degrees = [0] * n
    # Represent the graph as an adjacency list and record the in-degree of each
    # course.
```

```
queue = deque()
# Add all courses with an in-degree of 0 to the queue.
for i in range(n):
    if in_degrees[i] == 0:
        queue.append(i)
enrolled_courses = 0
# Perform topological sort.
while queue:
    node = queue.popleft()
    enrolled_courses += 1
    for neighbor in graph[node]:
        in_degrees[neighbor] -= 1
        # If the in-degree of a neighboring course becomes 0, add it to the queue
        if in_degrees[neighbor] == 0:
            queue.append(neighbor)
# Return true if we've successfully enrolled in all courses.
return enrolled_courses == n
```

Complexity Analysis

Time complexity: The time complexity of prerequisites is $O(n + e)$ where e denotes the number of edges derived from the prerequisites array. Here's why:

- Creating the adjacency list and recording the in-degrees takes $O(e)$ time because we iterate through each prerequisite once.
- Adding all courses with in-degree 0 to the queue takes $O(n)$ time because we check the in-degree of each course once.
- Performing Kahn's algorithm takes $O(n + e)$ time because each course and prerequisite is processed at most once during the traversal.

Space complexity: The space complexity is $O(n + e)$, since the adjacency list takes up $O(n + e)$ space, while the `in_degrees` array and queue each take up $O(n)$ space.

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